49. Baker and Allchin 1991: 61.
50. Lee (2006) documented the architectural remains to the west of Bamiyan proper; see also *infra* in main text, and Thomas 2018: app. 3.
51. For Sistan, cf. Fischer et al. 1974: illus. 36–38, 41, 43. Fischer (1971: 46, 50) also noted the regional developments within Sistan of certain building types and, above all, techniques of decoration, particularly the combination of mud-brick structures having a combination of stucco and *burnt*-brick decoration.
52. Bamiyan, together with the rest of Tukharistan, Balkh, Gharjistan, and Ghur, were given to Sabuktigin as a reward for his admirable victories in Khurasan on behalf of his Samanid overlords; cf. Bosworth 1973: 44; Baker and Allchin 1991: 22–24. According to al-Muqqadasi (*c.* 985 CE; cited in *ibid.*), by the time of Ghaznavid presence in the area in the tenth century, the town of Bamiyan was walled and had a congregational mosque, thriving market, several suburbs, and four city gates. Also noteworthy is the possibility that, both during and after Sultan Mahmud's reign and the Ghaznavids' firm hold over territories spanning from Ghazna through Balkh, wealthy non-Muslim merchants were still prominent in Bamiyan: Baihaqi praised the merchant Abaveyh, who rebuilt the bridge of Bamiyan "with a single arch, displaying great elegance and beauty" (Baihaqi [trans. Bosworth] vol. I, 2011: 367). The merchant's name appears to be a Persian transliteration of the Indic (perhaps Buddhist) *Abhaya*; although, Ashtiany offers the unlikely alternative that the name was a hypocoristic form of *'Abd Allah* (*ibid.*, vol. III, 2011: 167). Moreover, the Shars as the pre-Islamic dynasts of Bamiyan were kept in place during the Arab-'Umayyad and A'bbasid incursions, not being definitively eradicated even after the Saffarids' late ninth-century successes there (Le Berre et al. 1985–1988: 782–783).
53. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 348, 384 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 344, 361–362). Evidently, Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud appeared innocent of any collusion with the Madin Shansabanis, thus retaining the Bamiyan region as his appanage, passed on to his descendants for another three generations. By Juzjani implied that, by the reign of Ghiyath al-Din Muhammad (AH 553–599/1163–1203 CE) at Firuzkuh, the paramountcy of the *Firuzkuh* Shansabanis was firmly established over the others, as indicated by Ghiyath al-Din's personal conferral of the title "sultan" upon his cousin Shams al-Din Muhammad (r. AH 553–588/1163–1192 CE), perhaps the first of the Bamiyan rulers to receive it. See Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 378 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 427); see also *infra* in main text and notes; and for the contentious relations among the Shansabani branches, see Chapter 1.
54. Cf. Juzjani vol. I, 1963: 388 (trans. vol. I, 1881: 428–430); and Chapter 2.
55. While in the service of the Saljuq sultans Muhammad I (r. AH 498–512/1105–1118 CE) and Sanjar (r. AH 512–552/1118–1157 CE), Nizami 'Aruzi likely moved with the court throughout Khurasan, as glimpsed in the autobiographical introduction of the *Chahar Maqala* (cf. also Peacock 2015: 167). The circumstances in which he joined the Firuzkuh Shansabani court remain unknown, though it would be intriguing indeed to have his eyewitness view of his erstwhile patron Sanjar's defeat and capture of 'Ala' al-Din Husain near Herat in 1152/3 CE, and the reasons for Nizami 'Aruzi's own stay in hiding